

The Early Church in Acts

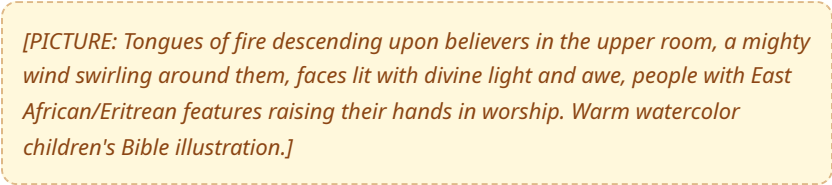
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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories
Book 59 of 60

Scene 2 of 25



Then it happened — the day of Pentecost arrived, and everything changed forever. Suddenly, a sound like a violent rushing wind filled the entire house. It wasn't just noise; it was the breath of God Himself entering the room. Then they saw what looked like tongues of fire separating and resting on each person. Every single believer was filled with the Holy Spirit and began speaking in languages they had never learned. The streets of Jerusalem were packed with Jewish pilgrims from every nation, and they heard these Galilean peasants speaking fluently in their own native languages. This was the moment Jesus had promised — not just power for a few leaders, but God's Spirit poured out on every believer, young and old, men and women alike.

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(Dihri'u tefetseme — me'alti Penteqoste betsihat, kulu neger dima nizeli'alem telewete. Bidnget kem birtu'e hibobla nifas zimesil dimtsi neta bet bimil'a mel'a. Tray dimtsi aykonenn neyru; tinfas Amlak ba'ilu nabta kifli yi'atu neyru. Kem lisanat hawi zimesil tefelaliyu ab nefsi wekef seb 'arefe. Kulom aminti biMenfes Qidus mel'u, zeyfelitwo qwanqwátat kizarebu dima jemeru.)

Scene 3 of 25

[PICTURE: Peter standing boldly before a massive crowd in Jerusalem, arm raised as he preaches with confidence and passion, his face transformed from fear to courage, crowd of diverse people with East African/Eritrean features listening intently. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Peter stood up — the same Peter who just weeks earlier had denied even knowing Jesus three times to save his own skin. The same man who hid behind locked doors in fear. But something was completely different now. Filled with the Holy Spirit, Peter raised his voice and preached to the massive crowd with a boldness that shocked everyone who knew him. He declared that Jesus, whom they had crucified, was both Lord and Messiah, risen from the dead. He didn't soften the message or try to be popular. He spoke truth with love and authority. This is what the Spirit does — He doesn't make us someone we're not, but He makes us who we were always meant to be. Peter was always meant to be a rock, and now the Spirit made it real.

[illegible]

(Petros dew bele — iti qidmi hidet semoonat ni'Iyesus kem zifelho seleste gize zikekhade Petros. Iti bifrhi dihiri 'itsuw ma'itso zitekhab'a seb'ay. Gina hiji kulu neger fitsum telewitu neyru. BiMenfes Qidus meli'u, Petros dimtsu ali'ilu neti 'abyi hizbi bitib'at sebeke — nizifelt'wo kulom zegereme tib'at.)

*zineberon sheyitom nizikone zidilyo 'adelu. Me'altawi ab abayti hadihidom bihagosin
biqin'inan libi bihabara bel'u.)*

Scene 6 of 25

[PICTURE: Peter and John at the Beautiful Gate of the temple, reaching down to a lame beggar who is beginning to rise with astonishment on his face, onlookers watching in amazement, East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

One afternoon, Peter and John walked toward the temple for prayer. At the gate called Beautiful, a man who had been lame from birth sat begging — this was his entire life, every single day, asking strangers for coins. When he asked Peter and John for money, Peter looked straight at him and said something unexpected: "Silver or gold I do not have, but what I do have I give you. In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, walk." Peter grabbed his hand and pulled him up, and instantly the man's feet and ankles became strong. He didn't just stand — he jumped, he leaped, he walked into the temple praising God. The people who had walked past this man for years were completely astonished. Peter used the moment to preach: this wasn't their own power, but the power of the risen Jesus working through them.

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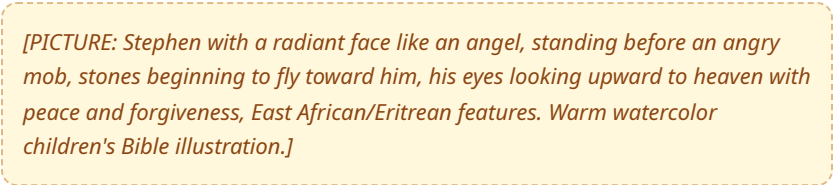
(Hade dihari qetri, Petrosin Yohansin nitselot nab bet meqdes kedu. Ab'ti "Tsibiqti" zibhal ma'itso, kab lidetu hankas zikone seb kof ilu yilmin neyru — izi milu'e hiywetu neyru, kulu me'alti niguanot genzeb yihatit. Petrosin Yohansin genzeb mis hatetom,

Petros qetita temeteto emo zeytetsbeyo neger tezarebe: "Birurn werqin yebleyin, gina zileni yihbeka. Bisim Iyesus Kristos Nazrawi tensí'e kid.")

NiPetrosin Yohansin asirom qidmi Sanhedrin gotetuom — iti ni'Iyesus ziferrede bayto. "Bikemey hayli wey bikemey sim izi geberkum?" telebu. Petros biMenfes meli'u bizey firhi tezarebe: "Bisim Iyesus Kristos Nazrawi eyu, nisikhatikum ziseqelkumwo gina Amlak kab mutan zitens'o.")

*moytu wedeqe, dihri se'atat Sepira dima temesasali hasot degemet temesasali 'icha
dima agatema.)*

Scene 9 of 25



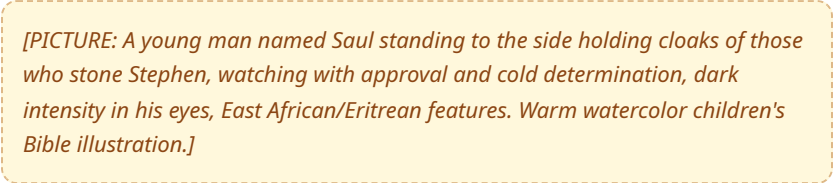
Stephen was a man full of God's grace and power who performed great wonders among the people. He was one of seven men chosen to serve the practical needs of the community, but his faith burned so brightly that he couldn't help but proclaim the gospel boldly. When jealous religious leaders arrested him and put him on trial, Stephen delivered a powerful sermon tracing God's faithfulness throughout history. His face shone like an angel's. But when he accused them of resisting the Holy Spirit just as their ancestors had, they were furious beyond control. They dragged him outside the city and stoned him. As rocks pounded his body, Stephen looked up to heaven, saw Jesus standing at the right hand of God, and cried out: "Lord, do not hold this sin against them." He died forgiving his killers — the first Christian martyr, showing that the same Spirit who raised Jesus could give supernatural forgiveness even in death.

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(Istifanos bigtsa Amlakn haylin zimeli'a seb neyru, ab ma'ikel hizbi 'abeyti te'amrat yigeber neyru. Kab'tom gib'rawi dilettat mahibereseb kegegilglu zitemertshu

shew'ate sebat hade neyru, gina imnettu kinditi birhan sile zinebere wengel bitib'at kab mi'iwaj kiquiteb ayke'alén. Qena'at nay haymanot merahti asirom mis feredwww, Istifanos tarikh ta'amninnét Amlak ziketatel hayal sibket aqrebe. "Goytay, iza hati'at ayti hazilom" ilu tsewi'u 'arefe.)

Scene 10 of 25

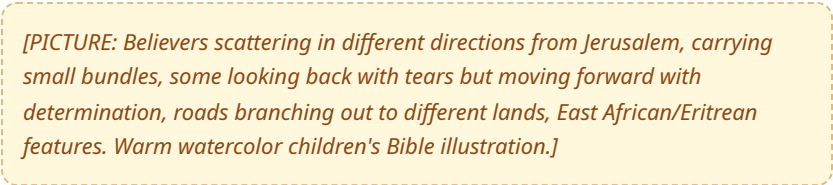


Standing nearby, watching it all, was a young man named Saul. The executioners laid their cloaks at his feet as they hurled stones at Stephen, and the Bible says Saul gave approval to his death. Saul was brilliant — a Pharisee trained by the best teacher in Jerusalem, zealous for God's law, absolutely convinced that this new "Way" was dangerous heresy that must be destroyed. He wasn't evil in his own eyes; he genuinely believed he was serving God by hunting down Christians. After Stephen's death, Saul went house to house, dragging men and women off to prison. He breathed murderous threats against the Lord's disciples. Here was the greatest enemy the young church faced — intelligent, passionate, relentless, and completely convinced he was right. Yet God had plans for Saul that would shock the entire world. Sometimes God's greatest instruments are hidden in the most unlikely people.

Ab tiqa dew ilu kulu yi'izeb zinebere Sawl zibhal hade men'esity neyru. Itom qetelti ni'Istifanos bi'imni kidibdibwo kelewo kidawintiom ab a'igaru aqemetsu, metshaf qidus ke'a Sawl nimotu kem zitesemam'alu yinigerena. Sawl biluts neyru —

*bizibelatse memhir Iyerusalem ziselitene Ferisawi, nihigi Amlak qena'i, iza hadis
"mengedi" kitidmeses zilewa hadegña sihtet mik'wana fitsum zi'amene.)*

Scene 11 of 25



Saul's persecution triggered something the religious leaders never expected. As believers fled Jerusalem to escape imprisonment and death, they carried the gospel with them everywhere they went. What was meant to destroy the church actually spread it — like scattering seeds in the wind, every place a believer landed became soil for a new community of faith. Persecution didn't silence the message; it amplified it. Believers went to Judea, Samaria, Phoenicia, Cyprus, and Antioch, sharing the good news wherever they traveled. God turned the enemy's weapon into His strategy. This pattern repeats throughout history: every attempt to crush the church only makes it grow stronger and wider. The harder you try to contain a wildfire, the more it spreads. The early Christians discovered that you cannot imprison an idea whose time has come, especially when that idea is backed by the living God.

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(Sidet Sawl nay haymanot merahti zeytetsbeye neger fetere. Aminti kab ma'isertin motin kimality kab Iyerusalem mis hademu, nab zikedu kulu wengel hizom kedu. Nibetekristyan ketifit'e zitehasbe bihaqi abazaha — zer'i ab nifas kem mibtan, amani

*ziwedequlu nefsi wekef bota nihadash mahibereseb imnet meret kone. Sidet neti
mel'ikhti ayetsrefon; a'ibeyo.)*

Scene 12 of 25



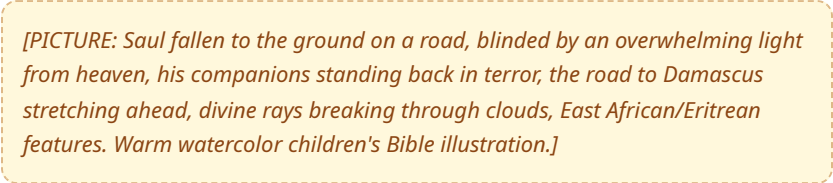
Philip was one of the scattered believers, and the Spirit led him on remarkable adventures. First he went to Samaria — a region Jews despised — and brought revival there through preaching and miracles. Then the Spirit gave him a strange instruction: go south to a desert road. There Philip found an Ethiopian official, a powerful man in charge of the queen's treasury, riding in his chariot and reading from the prophet Isaiah. "Do you understand what you're reading?" Philip asked. "How can I, unless someone explains it to me?" the man replied. Philip climbed in and, starting from that very passage about a suffering servant, told him the good news about Jesus. The Ethiopian believed immediately and was baptized in water they found along the road. He went home to Africa rejoicing, carrying the gospel to an entirely new continent. God's mission doesn't follow human plans — it follows divine appointments.

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(Filipos kab'tom zitebatatenu aminti hade neyru, Menfes dima ab zideniq gu'izotati merho. Felema nab Samarya kede — Ayhud ziniq'wo zoba — bisibketin te'amratin

hidase amtse'a. Dihri'u Menfes zeyilmud ti'izaz habo: nab debub nab midrebeda mengedi kid. Ab'u Filipos nay Ityopya seb siltan rekebe — nay nigisti gimja bet halafi zikone hayal seb — ab seregela'u kof ilu kab nebiy Isayyas yinebib neyru. "Zinebbo tird'o dika?" Filipos hatete. "Zigeltseley inte zeyhalewe bikemey yikhil?" melese.)

Scene 13 of 25



Saul was on his way to Damascus with letters authorizing him to arrest any followers of the Way he found there. He was breathing murderous threats, absolutely certain of his mission. Then suddenly, a light from heaven — brighter than the noonday sun — blazed around him and he fell to the ground. A voice spoke: "Saul, Saul, why do you persecute me?" "Who are you, Lord?" Saul asked, trembling. "I am Jesus, whom you are persecuting." In that blinding moment, Saul's entire world collapsed. Everything he had believed about God, about righteousness, about these "heretics" he was hunting — all of it was wrong. The one he thought was a dead criminal was alive and speaking to him from glory. Saul rose from the ground blind, led by the hand into Damascus, and for three days he neither ate nor drank, overwhelmed by the revolution happening in his soul.

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(Sawl ab'u zirekebon tekhateleti mengedi kem zi'asir zifiqdu debdabettat hizu nab Demasqo yigu'a'az neyru. Qetali mifrirah yitinfis neyru, bi'ilama'u fitsum rigtsnya.

Dihri'u bidnget birhan kab semay — kab qetrawi tsehay ziberh — ab kebabu'u nedede emo nab meret wedeqe. Dimtsi tezarebe: "Sawl, Sawl, slemintay tisegoni?" "Men ika Goyta?" Sawl biminqitiqat hatete. "Niska tisegoni zileka Iyesus eye.")

Scene 14 of 25

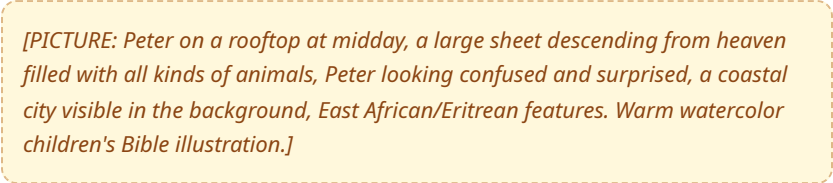
[PICTURE: Barnabas with his arm around Saul/Paul, introducing him to suspicious apostles in Jerusalem, Barnabas's face warm and encouraging while others look uncertain and wary, East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When Saul — now transformed — tried to join the believers in Jerusalem, they were terrified of him. And who could blame them? This was the man who had thrown their friends in prison, who had approved of Stephen's murder. Was this some kind of trick to infiltrate their community? Everyone kept their distance. But one man stepped forward: Barnabas, whose name means "Son of Encouragement." Barnabas took Saul to the apostles and vouched for him, telling them about his conversion and his bold preaching in Damascus. Because Barnabas believed in Saul when no one else would, the door opened for Saul to become part of the community that would eventually send him to change the world. Never underestimate the power of being the one person who believes in someone others have written off. Barnabas saw what Saul could become, not just what he had been. Every great leader needs a Barnabas.

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(Sawl — hiji zitelewete — ab Iyerusalem nitom aminti kitsniber mis fetene, tesekefu. Men yiwqisom? Izi iti a'irukhtiom ab bet ma'iserti ziderbeye, nimot Istifanos zitesemam'e seb eyu neyru. Gina hade seb niqidmit wetse, Bernabas — simu "Wedi Mitibba'i" malet eyu. Bernabas niSawl nab hawariyat wesidu bizi'iba milwatun ab Demasqo bitib'at misbakun negiru ni'u tekhaz'alu.)

Scene 15 of 25



Peter was praying on a rooftop when he fell into a trance. He saw heaven opened and something like a large sheet descending, filled with all kinds of animals — clean and unclean according to Jewish law. A voice said, "Get up, Peter. Kill and eat." Peter was horrified: "Surely not, Lord! I have never eaten anything impure or unclean." The voice responded: "Do not call anything impure that God has made clean." This happened three times. Peter was deeply puzzled, but then messengers arrived from a Roman centurion named Cornelius, a Gentile who feared God. The Spirit told Peter to go with them without hesitation. God was shattering Peter's categories — the wall between Jew and Gentile, between "us" and "them," was coming down. The gospel wasn't just for one people group; it was for everyone. God was teaching Peter that His love has no ethnic, cultural, or social boundaries.

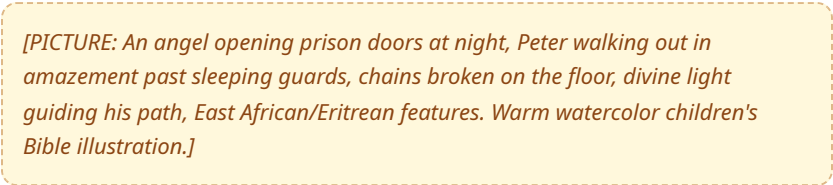
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(Petros ab nahsi yitsili kelo ab ra'iy atewe. Semay tekefitu kem 'abyi cherqi zimesil neger bikulu 'aynet insisa zimeli'a — bihigi Ayhud nitsuhatn rikrusatn — kiwerd re'aye. Dimtsi "Tensi'e Petros, hired bil'a" bele. Petros senbede: "Fetsimu ayikun Goyta! Rikrus wey zeynitsuh neger beli'e ayfeltin." Iti dimtsi melese: "Amlak zinitsha rikrus ayitbelo." Izi seleste gize tedegeme.)

*kibhal kem zeygiba'i ari'iywo neyru. Petros bizi'iba Iyesus kisebik mis jemere,
zeyilmud neger tefetseme: Menfes Qidus ab kulom zisem'u zineberu ahzab werede —
kem'ti ab Pentegoste ab Ayhud aminti ziwerede. Bilisanat tezarebu ni'Amlak dima
amesgenu.)*

bizuhāt dima amenu. Nay Iyerusalem betekristyan bizi'iba iza zitefelaleyet zi'abya mahibereseb mis sem'e niBernabas kir'iya le'akhe. Zirekebo bihaggos mel'o — haqeña tsega ab sirah. Bernabas niSawl kab Terses amtsi'u bihabara nihade milu'e 'amet neta ti'abi betekristyan meharu. Abzi ab Antsokhya aminti nifelema "Kristyanat" tebaihilom — na'ishtu Kristosat.)

Scene 18 of 25



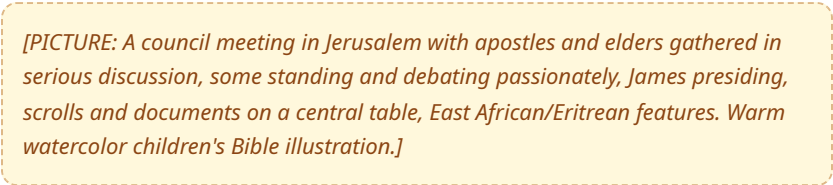
King Herod Agrippa began persecuting the church. He had James, the brother of John, killed with the sword — the first apostle to be martyred. Seeing that this pleased the Jewish leaders, he arrested Peter and threw him in prison, chained between two soldiers with guards at the door, planning to execute him after Passover. The church prayed earnestly for Peter without stopping. The night before his trial, an angel appeared in the cell. "Quick, get up!" the angel said, and the chains fell from Peter's wrists. He followed the angel past guard after guard — no one noticed — and through the iron gate that opened by itself. Peter thought he was dreaming until the cool night air hit his face. He went to a house where believers were gathered praying, and when the servant girl Rhoda heard his voice, she was so overjoyed she forgot to open the door. The praying church almost couldn't believe their own prayers had been answered.

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(Nigus Herods Agrippa nibetekristyan kisedid jemere. Ni'Ya'iqob haw Yohansin biseyfi qetelo — qedamay hawarya nisim'e zimote. Izi ninay Ayhud merahti kem zihagosom mis re'aye, niPetros asiru ab bet ma'iserti derbeyo — ab mengo kilte wetehaderat bisenselet te'asiru bizuhat halewti dima ab ma'itso — dihri fasika kiquetlo hasibu. Betekristyan bizey miqwrats bitighat niPetros tseleyet.)

(Nay Antsokhya betekristyan ab amilkhon tsomin kela Menfes Qidus binitsur tezarebe: "NiBernabasin Sawlin neti zitsewa'ikuwom sirah fileyuley." Dihri tsomin tselotin betekristyan a'idawa anbira le'akhetom — ab tarikh nay mejemerta 'ilama zilwo misyonawi gu'izo. Izi kilte beynom tsewa'iti binatom ziwetsu aykonnun — bitsalotin degeefin zidigefu zibeletshu merahta tilikh mahibereseb neyra.)

Scene 20 of 25



As Gentiles flooded into the church, a serious conflict erupted. Some Jewish believers insisted that Gentile converts must be circumcised and follow the entire Jewish law to be saved. This wasn't a minor disagreement — it threatened to split the movement in two. So the apostles and elders gathered in Jerusalem to resolve it. After much discussion, Peter reminded them how God had given the Spirit to Gentiles without requiring the law. Paul and Barnabas shared stories of God's work among the nations. Then James, the brother of Jesus, proposed a solution: Gentiles should not be burdened with Jewish law, but should avoid a few practices tied to idolatry. The council agreed and sent a letter to Gentile churches. This moment teaches us something profound: the early church handled disagreement not by splitting or silencing people, but by listening, discussing, and seeking the Spirit's guidance together. Conflict, handled well, produces clarity.

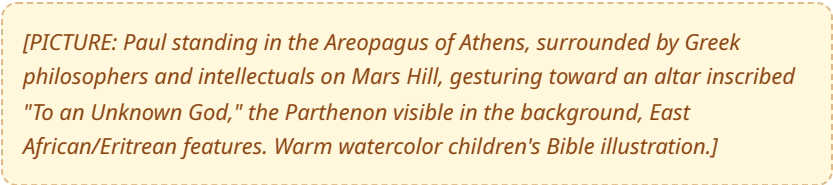
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(Ahzab nab betekristyan mis hatsetsu, kebid girijit tele'ale. Gele Ayhud aminti nay ahzab miluwat kidihnu kigizeruns bimlu'e higi Ayhud kikitelun kem zilewom atsn'i'om tezarebu. Izi ni'us mifihiyah aykonenn — neti minqisqas nab kilte kifelho ziferirah neyru. Sle'zi hawariyatn 'abeyltin nimfitahu ab Iyerusalem te'akebu. Dihri bizuh miyiyit Petros Amlak bizey higi ni'ahzab Menfes kem zihabe azekerom.)

Ἰσῆρος ἡμεῖς οὐκ ἔσμεν ἡμεῖς οὐκ ἔσμεν οὐκ ἔσμεν "ἡμεῖς οὐκ ἔσμεν!
οὐκ ἔσμεν οὐκ ἔσμεν!" οὐκ

*(Ab ketema Filipi Pawlosin Silasin bibetri teweqi'om ab wishti bet ma'iserti
tederbiyom, a'igarom ab gudguad te'asiru. Niketema sile zizanefu te'asirom — bihaqi
gina kab kifu'e menfes niwanataita genzeb zewts'ala barya gual sile zinagefu.
Hiqo'om yidemi neyru, bet ma'iserti tselimatin ritibtin neyra. Gina ab firqi leyti kindi
zimareru wey ziteqebitsu, Pawlosin Silasin yitsiliyin ni'Amlak mezmur yizimirun
neyrom.)*

Scene 22 of 25



Paul arrived in Athens, the intellectual capital of the ancient world, and his spirit was stirred by the countless idols filling the city. Rather than simply condemning the culture, Paul engaged with it brilliantly. He debated with Epicurean and Stoic philosophers, and they invited him to speak at the Areopagus — Mars Hill — where new ideas were discussed. Paul didn't start by quoting Jewish Scripture that his audience wouldn't recognize. Instead, he started where they were: "I see that in every way you are very religious. I even found an altar with the inscription 'TO AN UNKNOWN GOD.' What you worship as something unknown, I now proclaim to you." He quoted their own poets, acknowledged their seeking, and then declared the truth about the God who made the world and doesn't live in temples made by human hands. Paul shows us how to engage culture — not with fear or hostility, but with confidence, intelligence, and respect, building bridges from what people already know to what they need to hear.

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(Pawlos ab Atens betsiha — nay tinti 'alem hagere a'imro — menfesu dima neta ketema zimel'wa qutsri albo ta'otat teneqanqe. Nibahli kindi zikunin bitibeb tesatefo. Mis Epiquriyanin Sto'ikin felasifatat tekarakhere, hadesiti hasabat zizileylu ab Aryosfagos — korebta Mars — kizareb dima 'ademwo. Pawlos sema'itu zeyeleliyo tsihuf Ayhud bimitiqas ayjemereren. Ab kindu'u kab zilewlu jemere: "Bikulu mengedi azkum haymanotenyatat mik'wankum yir'i aleku.")

Scene 23 of 25

[PICTURE: Paul speaking with passion to the Athenians, his hands open in a gesture of proclamation, some listeners nodding thoughtfully while others scoff, the words "In Him we live and move and have our being" floating above in beautiful script, East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Standing before the philosophers of Athens, Paul delivered one of the most profound theological statements in all of Scripture: "The God who made the world and everything in it is the Lord of heaven and earth. He does not live in temples built by human hands, nor is He served by human hands as if He needed anything. Rather, He himself gives everyone life and breath and everything else. From one man He made all the nations, that they should inhabit the whole earth. He determined the times set for them and the exact places where they should live. God did this so that they would seek Him and perhaps reach out for Him and find Him, though He is not far from any one of us. For in Him we live and move and have our being." This message reminds us that God is not distant or irrelevant — every breath we take, every heartbeat, every moment of existence is sustained by Him. He is closer than we imagine, and He placed each of us exactly where we are so we might find Him.

Paul said to the philosophers of Athens, "I see that you are very religious. I found an altar with this inscription: 'TO THE UNKNOWN GOD.' So what you worship without knowing, I proclaim to you: The God who made the world and everything in it, who is Lord of heaven and earth, does not live in temples made by man, nor is he served by human hands, since he himself gives life and breath to all of us. From one man he made all the nations, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and he has determined the times for their living, and the places where they will live. He is not far from each one of us, for in him we live and move and have our being. As he himself says, 'In him we live and move and have our being.'"

ἡμεῖς οὖν ὡς ἴσμεν ὅτι οὐκ ἔστιν ἡμεῖς — οὐκ ἔστιν ἡμεῖς οὐκ ἔστιν ἡμεῖς
οὐκ ἔστιν ἡμεῖς οὐκ ἔστιν ἡμεῖς οὐκ ἔστιν ἡμεῖς

*(Qidmi felasifatat Atens dew ilu Pawlos ab kulu tsihuf kab zibelitshu 'amiq nay sene-
melekot qalat aqrebe: "Alemn ab'a zelo kulun zifetera Amlak Goyta semayin midrin
eyu. Biseb zitesirhe bet meqdes aynebirin, gele zidiliyo kem zilwo bi'id seb aygiligelin.
Ab kindu'u nikulu hiywetin tinfasin kulu negerin ba'ilu yihib. Kab hade seb nikulum
ahzab gebere, nimidri bimil'ita kinebru. Bi'u nineber ninqesaqes nihilu ina.")*

Scene 24 of 25

[PICTURE: Paul arriving in Rome as a prisoner, yet preaching boldly from his rented house with a chain on his wrist, visitors streaming in to hear him, the great city of Rome visible through a window, East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

After years of missionary journeys, shipwrecks, beatings, imprisonments, and near-death experiences, Paul finally reached Rome — the capital of the world's greatest empire. He arrived not as a conquering hero but as a prisoner in chains, awaiting trial before Caesar. Yet even in chains, Paul was unstoppable. He rented a house and for two full years welcomed everyone who came to him, "proclaiming the kingdom of God and teaching about the Lord Jesus Christ with all boldness and without hindrance." The book of Acts ends here — not with a dramatic conclusion but with an open door. The gospel that started with 120 people in an upper room in Jerusalem had reached the center of the known world. From a crucified Jewish carpenter in an obscure Roman province, the message had spread across continents. No army carried it. No government promoted it. No wealth funded it. Just ordinary people, empowered by an extraordinary Spirit, refusing to be silent about what they had witnessed.

Paul arrived in Rome as a prisoner, yet preaching boldly from his rented house with a chain on his wrist, visitors streaming in to hear him, the great city of Rome visible through a window, East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.

(Dihri 'amettat misyonawi gu'izo, misbar merkeb, mahremti, ma'iserti, nab mot ziqerebe temekrottat, Pawlos ab meweda'ita nab Roma betsiha — nay 'alem zi'abeye giz'at ri'ise ketema. Kem zisi'ir jigna zeyikone kem isur bisenselet betsiha, qidmi Qesar firdi yitsibe neyru. Gina ab senselet ikwa Pawlos zey'iget neyru. Bet tekariyu nimilu'e kilte 'amet nizimetso kulu seb teqebilu "Mengisti Amlak ina'aweje bizi'iba Goyta Iyesus Kristos bimilu'e tib'at bizey 'inqifat yimhir neyru.")

Scene 25 of 25

[PICTURE: A bridge between ancient and modern times - on one side early believers in biblical clothing, on the other side modern young people of diverse backgrounds serving their communities, a golden thread of the Spirit connecting them across time, East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The book of Acts has no final "amen" — and that's intentional. The story isn't over. You are reading chapter 29 of Acts right now, because the same Spirit who empowered those first believers lives in every follower of Jesus today. The early church wasn't special because they were perfect — they had conflicts, failures, and flaws. They were special because they were available. They said yes to God when it was dangerous, inconvenient, and costly. They shared their lives radically with each other. They crossed every barrier that divided humanity. They spoke truth to power. They served the poor. They forgave their enemies. And they did all of this not through their own strength, but through the Spirit living inside them. You are part of this same story. Your school, your neighborhood, your city — these are your Jerusalem, your Judea, your ends of the earth. The same power that raised Jesus from the dead is available to you. The question is not whether God can use you. The question is: will you let Him?

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(Metshaf Gibri Hawariyat nay meweda'ita "Amen" yeblun — izi dima bi'ilama eyu. Iti zanta aywed'an. Hiji mi'iraf 29 nay Gibri Hawariyat tinbib aleka, mikniyatu iti nitom qedamot aminti zihayele Menfes lomi ab nefsi wekef teketali Iyesus yinebir. Nay mejemerta betekristyan filuyat aynberun fitsumat sile zineberu — girijitat, widqetat, gudletat neyromom. Filuyat neyrom mikniyatu zirkebu sile zineberu. Niska nayza temesasalit zanta ika. Bet timhirtika, kebabika, ketemaka — izi'atom natka Iyerusalem, natka Yihuda, natka wesen midri eyom.)

The Moral of the Story

The Holy Spirit empowers ordinary people to do extraordinary things. The early church was not a building or an institution — it was a movement of people living in radical love, sacrificial generosity, and fearless courage. Fishermen became world-changers. Persecutors became apostles. Slaves and masters became brothers. Walls that divided humanity for centuries crumbled before the power of the gospel.

The church is not something you attend — it is something you are. When the Spirit of God fills ordinary people who are willing to be used, nothing in this world can stop what He begins. Not persecution, not prison, not poverty, not even death itself.

Key Verse - Acts 1:8

"You will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth."

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Discussion Questions

1. The early church shared everything and lived in radical community. What would it look like for your generation to live out that kind of generosity and togetherness today? What barriers make it difficult, and how might you begin to break them down?
2. Peter went from denying Jesus out of fear to preaching boldly before thousands. What does his transformation tell us about how God views our past failures? Is there an area of your life where fear is holding you back from what God might be calling you to do?
3. Paul engaged with the culture of Athens respectfully and intelligently rather than condemning it. How can you engage with your own culture — social media, school, entertainment — in a way that builds bridges for the gospel rather than burning them?
4. The book of Acts ends without a conclusion because the story continues through us. What "chapter" of Acts might God be writing through your life right now? What would it take for you to say yes to being part of His ongoing story?
5. The early church faced persecution and opposition, yet they described it as joy and privilege. How do you respond when living out your faith becomes costly or unpopular?

What can we learn from Paul and Silas singing in prison
about facing hardship with faith?

A Prayer for Boldness and Love

Lord God, You are the same yesterday, today, and forever. The same Spirit who filled Peter with boldness, who transformed Saul into Paul, who shook prison walls and opened closed doors — that same Spirit lives in us today.

Give us the courage of Stephen, who spoke truth even when it cost him everything. Give us the generosity of the early church, who held nothing back from one another. Give us the vision of Paul, who saw every culture and every person as beloved by You. Give us the heart of Barnabas, who believed in people when no one else would.

We confess that we often choose comfort over courage, isolation over community, and silence over witness. Forgive us, and fill us afresh with Your Spirit. Make us the kind of church that turns the world upside down — not through power or wealth, but through radical love that cannot be explained apart from You.

We are ordinary people, Lord. But with Your Spirit, we are enough. Use us to continue the story of Acts in our generation. May people look at our lives and see Jesus, just as they did in those first believers.

In the mighty name of Jesus Christ, Amen.

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1. The early church was made up of ordinary people, but they had extraordinary power.
 2. This power came from the Holy Spirit, who lived with them and worked through them.
 3. The Holy Spirit gave them the ability to do miracles, heal the sick, and speak in tongues.
 4. The early church was a community of people who loved each other and shared everything they had.
 5. They were a light to the world, and their love and power drew many people to them.

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

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